THE REDEEMED CHRISTIAN CHURCH OF GOD

THE DIRECTORATE OF CHRISTIAN EDUCATION

(DCE, RCBC, RCM & CRSM)

DCE

2025 TRAINING WEEKEND

Theme:

TEACHING IN-AND-OUT OF SEASON

-2 Timothy 4:2.

VENUE:	DATE:
ALL PARISHES	JUNE 12TH-15TH, 2025.

Sunday School Hymn

1. O Sunday School, on the Lord's day,
O how I love Thee well,
I am happy, it makes me glad
To rejoice at Thy birth.

2. O Sunday School, on the Lord's day,
Thy friend friendship suits me well,
Both young and old will sing Thy song,
We long for Sunday School.

3. O Sunday School, on the Lord's day,
Christ was Thy first teacher,
The Holy Spirit, great teacher,
Does manifest in thee.

4. O Sunday School, on the Lord's day,
This testimony is sure,
That God, the Father Almighty,
Poured His blessing on Thee.

5. O Sunday School, on the Lord's day,
Though the sun be so bright,
Or if the clouds be black with rain,
I'll be in Sunday School.

6. O Sunday School, on the Lord's day,
I rejoice to see Thee,
Will thou pass over me today?
Without my being blest?

PROGRAMME OF EVENTS

DATE	DAY	ACTIVITIES
12/06/2025	THURSDAY	FAITH CLINIC: THE RESILIENT CHRISTIAN
13/06/2025	FRIDAY	VIGIL : "TEACHING IN AND OUT OF SEASON"
14/06/2025	SATURDAY	EVANGELISM/SEMINAR ANNIVERSARY LECTURE, CHRISTIAN SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY, GET TOGETHER, ETC... "TEACHING IN AND OUT OF SEASON"
15/06/2025	SUNDAY SERVICE	"HEEDING THE DOCTRINES"

FOREWORD

We thank God for another Training Weekend. The theme for this year is, TEACHING IN AND OUT OF SEASON. In **2Timothy 4:2**, the Apostle Paul urged Timothy to preach the word of God consistently, regardless of the circumstances, whether people are receptive or not. In season can be interpreted to mean when people are open to receiving the message of Christ and with positive response. Out of season can refer to times when people are not receptive and when there is open resistance. This, especially at the times we are in now, vividly emphasises the importance of diligent teaching and the unwavering commitment to sharing the truth at all times.

As teachers of the word of God, we have to be instant or be ready in both situations. This involves constant diligence and preparedness to share the undiluted word of God. There should also be effective teaching because Paul actually instructed Timothy to correct, reprove, rebuke and encourage with patience. We need this attitude or stand at this time because we are in a time when people are more receptive to false teachings and reject sound doctrines. Reproving involves correcting false beliefs or behaviours. To encourage involves building up believers. Patient instruction suggests a gentle but persistent approach. This is essential in teaching because patience is a fruit of the Spirit – **Gal.5:22.**

Also, the teaching ministry requires more prayers than ever before. With prayers, we can bring down the high walls of resistance and opposition.

As teachers of God's word, there is need for readiness and perseverance in our ministry, regardless of circumstances. We must be vigilant – **1 Peter 3:15** and be ready at all times – **Matthew 25:1-13**. As in the early Church, false teachings are prevalent in the present day, so this admonition by Paul to Timothy is timely for we teachers.

This is also our admonition to you during this Training Weekend and we pray that you will come out strong, bold and ready to correct, rebuke and reprove against false doctrines and encourage with patience as you perfect the saints.

KEYNOTE ADDRESS

Kindly note that all reports, including records of attendance as well as offerings collected are to please be forwarded through the Pastor-In-Charge of Province to the Directorate of Christian Education on behalf of the other units. Please also note that 30% of the offering is to be held back in the Province and shared pro-rata amongst the Sunday School Department, RCBC, CRSM and School of Missions. The remaining 70% goes to the DCE.

We will appreciate it if no other programme is slated for this period of the Training Weekend since this is a national programme.

Pastor Ezekiel A. Odeyemi
Assistant General Overseer (Education and Training),
Continental Overseer, Continent 2.

KEYNOTE ADDRESS

"Preach the word; be instant in season, out of season; reprove, rebuke, exhort with all longsuffering and doctrine." **2 Timothy 4:2**

INTRODUCTION

Teaching is not just a modern day job, it is in fact, one of the oldest professions in the world, and the foundation of all learning. Long before there were doctors, lawyers, or engineers, there were teachers. These were men and women who passed down wisdom, preserved truth, and shaped the future.

From the dawn of civilization, parents taught children, elders taught communities, and spiritual leaders taught the ways of God. In the Scriptures, we see that God Himself was the first teacher, instructing Adam in the garden, Jesus our Lord, was called "Rabbi", meaning teacher, and when He commissioned the disciples, He said:

"Teach them to observe all I have commanded you." **(Matthew 28:20)**

As we observe the Training Weekend this year with the theme: "Teaching in and out of Season", it is instructive to note that teaching is not just a profession but a calling. Therefore, we do not just teach to inform minds, but to transforms lives.

We live in an age where truth is increasingly treated as opinion, where itching ears seek pleasant words, and where sound doctrine is under attack. Yet, in the face of these apparent cultural shifts, social and societal reorientation and spiritual apathy, the Word of God remains unchanging.

Paul's charge to Timothy in **2 Timothy 4:2** is also God's charge to us today:Whether the environment is favorable or hostile, whether we are applauded or ignored we are to teach the Word faithfully!

What Does It Mean to Teach In and Out of Season?

1. To teach in season implies when it is convenient and the conditions are favourable, such as:

- When the people are hungry for the Word.
- When there's spiritual revival.
- When the Church is growing.
- And when you are inspired

In these moments, we must seize the opportunity to lay strong foundations.

2. On the other hand, to teach out of season means that the conditions are unfavourable and challenging. This may include;

- When the audience is distracted or uninterested.
- When society labels truth as intolerance.
- When you're tired, discouraged, or unappreciated.
- And when there is persecution

Even then we must teach!

God is not looking for seasonal servants. He is looking for faithful vessels who will carry His truth without compromise, year in, year out.

Teaching is not only about passing information; it is about imparting revelation therefore it is a sacred trust. **James 3:1** warns: ***"Not many of you should become teachers… because you know that we who teach will be judged more strictly."***

So in our teaching we should:

- Correct falsehood
- Rebuke sin lovingly
- Encourage the fainthearted
- Give godly counsel and instruction
- Build disciples, not just members, and
- Glory the Lord Jesus Christ

In today's fast-paced world, we may adjust our methods to connect with different generations,through technology, creative visuals and digital platforms, but whatever method we adopt, we must never compromise the message.

As we train and teach in our churches, classrooms, fellowships, and families, let us:

- Be rooted in Scripture- not trends.
- Be filled with the Spirit - not flesh.
- Be ready to serve- in every condition, whether thanked or forgotten.
- Be consistent and credible - because our lives must reflect our message.

Teaching in and out of season is not just about availability, it's about spiritual endurance. We are not entertainers, neither are wemotivational speakers, we are messengers of eternal truth.

May we rise from this weekendrenewed in our calling, refined in our methods, and reignited in our passion to teach the Word of God with accuracy, boldness, and love, no matter the season.

God bless you

Pastor Oladele A. Balogun
Special Assistant to the General Overseer [Admin]

THE RESILIENT CHRISTIAN

Proverbs 24.10

"If you faint in the day of adversity, your strength is small."

Resilience is the ability to overcome obstacles, solve problems, and bounce back from difficult situations. Resilience is the quality of being able to adapt to stressful life changes and "bouncing back" from hardship. Resilience is the human heart's ability to suffer greatly and grow from it.

A resilient Christian is someone who faces adversity with faith and trust in God. They use their faith to find strength and guidance through difficult times.

Christians are redeemed by grace, and have access to the strength and power of the risen Christ. Because of this, it is essential that we seek the Lord for the strength to be resilient in the face of life's challenges and difficulties.

Like Joseph, we may not comprehend the full scope of God's plan amid trials, but we trust that He is working all things together for our good.

Examples of Resilient characters in the Bible:
Examples include Job, Jesus and Esther. Resilience in the Bible is characterised by faith in God, trusting in His plan and maintaining integrity.

ESTHER

Esther is considered one of the greatest examples of godly resilience in the Bible. Despite the risk of death—going unrequested to the king was highly illegal—Esther agreed, saying, "***If I perish, I perish***" **(v. 16).**

Esther showed incredible boldness, courage, and resilience, using her position of power and influence to help those in need—even when God felt absent to her and her people.

JOB

Job demonstrated resilience after losing everything, refusing to curse God or give up – **Job 1:22; Job 2:9.** Job's faith in God helped him maintain resilience and not give in to defeat. Despite his suffering, Job knew that God was in control and that knowledge helped him maintain resilience instead of giving in to defeat.

PAUL

Paul showed great resilience after his life-altering encounter with Jesus in **Acts 9.** He was beaten, stoned, criticised, jailed and nearly killed many times – **2 Corinthians 11:24-27.**

JESUS

The crucifixion, death and resurrection of Jesus are examples of resilience. The resilience of Jesus came from knowing that the suffering would be worth it in the end. Jesus was resilient because He knew the suffering would all be worth it in the end. He had set His mind on the reward that awaited Him and this gave Him the strength to finish well.

Characteristics of a resilient Christian

Trusts God: Believes God's grace and truth will help through challenges. Trust in God's plan, even when circumstances seem insurmountable - **Psalm 9:10.** Believing in God's sovereignty means acknowledging His control over all situations, even amid uncertainty and adversity. Trusting in His wisdom and goodness allows us to surrender our fears and anxieties, knowing that He works all things together for our good **(Romans 8:28).**

Has Faith: Maintain faith and integrity. – **Heb.11:1; 2 Cor.5:7; Jam.1:6.** Choosing to focus on God's faithfulness and the blessings amidst trials fosters a positive mindset. **Philippians 4:8** encourages us to dwell on whatever is true, noble, right, pure, lovely, and admirable.

Hopes: Hope in the Lord renews strength and forms resilience. – **Jer.29:11; Is.40:31.**

Prays and studies the Bible: Resilient Christians pray for strength, wisdom, and the power of the Holy Spirit. Resilient Christians pray boldly and approach the throne of grace with confidence. They know the Lord understands us and He understands the situation, even if we do not. – **Heb.4:14-16; Hab.3:17-19.** Regular prayer and immersion in the word provide spiritual nourishment and guidance, enabling us to navigate challenges with faith and confidence **(Psalm 119:105).**They read and apply the truth and promises of scripture.

Worships: They praise and worship God, even when facing difficulties. Worship is a powerful weapon against despair and doubt. Engaging in heartfelt worship shifts our focus from problems to God's greatness, reminding us of His presence and power.

Embraces trials as opportunities for growth: James 1:2-4 encourages us to consider trials as opportunities for spiritual maturity.

Remains flexible and adaptable: Life is full of unexpected twists and turns, requiring flexibility and adaptability. **-Proverbs 16:9.**

Practices forgiveness: Unresolved resentment and bitterness can hinder our resilience and spiritual growth. **-Ephesians 4:31-32**.

By incorporating these practices into our lives, we can cultivate resilience and stay strong in our faith during difficult times, trusting in God's unfailing love and provision.

One enemy of resilience is the incorrect assumption that we know how things will end. So, instead of exercising resilience, we give up or take matters into our own hands. We should always rely on **Proverbs 3:5-6:**

"Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths."

HEEDING THE DOCTRINES

"Take heed unto thyself, and unto the doctrine; continue in them: for in doing this thou shalt both save thyself, and them that hear thee."
-1 Timothy 4:16 (KJV)

These days, many Christians look for ways to water down certain doctrines and prove that they are useless. In Scripture, doctrine refers to the entire body of essential theological truths that define and describe that message (**1 Tim 1:10** ; **4:16** ; **6:3** ; **Titus 1:9**). Doctrine is scriptural teaching on theological truths. Doctrine is indispensable to Christianity. Christianity does not exist without it. The New Testament repeatedly emphasises the value and importance of sound doctrine, sound instruction (**1 Tim 6:3**), and a pattern of sound teaching (**2 Tim 1:13-14**). Pastors in particular were admonished to cleave to sound doctrine so that they could be good ministers of the gospel (**1 Tim 4:6**).

1 Timothy 4:16 is but one of many examples of Paul's insistence on right doctrine. He is instructing the young elder brother to pay attention to right doctrine, and make sure he adheres to it continually. Moreover, Paul states that Timothy's very salvation, and the salvation of those who listen to Timothy, depends upon this. Later on, in this same epistle **(1 Timothy 6:3)**, Paul follows up by saying those whose teachings do not consent to the "***wholesome words of our Lord Jesus Christ, and to the doctrine which is according to godliness***", are proud, know nothing, and must be avoided.

The need to maintain doctrinal clarity was not to diminish with the passing of time. This becomes especially obvious when we consider the proliferation of both deliberate heresies and unintentional error. Disagreements on what the word of God means have brought us to this point in church history where irreconcilable differences exist between professing Christians. Doctrinal plurality and the resulting disunity have led to widespread confusion and frustration. It is systemic within the contemporary Christian Church.

To take heed means to pay attention to something and be cautious or careful about it. It implies being alert and mindful of potential risks or

warnings. Heeding the doctrine means paying close attention to the teachings of the Bible. The Bible instructs people to "***take heed to themselves and to the doctrine***" in **1 Timothy 4:16.**

Why heed the doctrine?

- To save oneself from false teachings, errors, and heresies.
- To save others from erroneous principles and immoral practices.
- To be an example to others in doctrine and conversation.
- To be able to refute false teaching and defend one's faith.

Why is heeding the doctrine important?

Heeding the doctrine is important because it helps people avoid being led astray by false teachings. In taking heed to the doctrines:

1. Be sure you have a thoroughly developed idea of what constitutes true religion. Nothing is more common than for ministers and people to make a mistake here.

2. Take heed that you preach the whole doctrine of the gospel. Many ministers seem able to preach sinners under conviction, but can go no farther. They can make sinners see their sins, but cannot tell them how to get rid of them. Others still can tell sinners how they may be forgiven, but cannot tell Christians how they may be sanctified. You must be qualified to preach to them the higher doctrines of grace, and to preach them from your own experience, or you can do them comparatively little good.

3. Take heed that you live out the doctrine of Christ. Remember that the doctrine of the gospel is not taught merely in the pulpit. It is often most emphatically and impressively taught out of the pulpit by the temper, spirit, and life of a disciple.

What is intended by continuing in them? By continuing in them is meant, the continuing to take heed to your doctrine. Remember that if at any time, or under any pretense, you neglect to take heed to the doctrine, to continue in them, God will cast you off.

CONCLUSION

Doctrines raised from the Scriptures will set you apart from the world. They are a great catalyst for your spiritual growth and well-being. Doctrines are not there to imprison you but to further strengthen your consecration to God.



HOLY GHOST Service

● FIRST FRIDAY OF EVERY MONTH ●

● AT THE REDEMPTION CITY ●

Time: 7:00pm Till Dawn

Redemption City of God, Km 46, Mowe, Lagos-Ibadan Expressway, Ogun State.
Ministering: Pastor E.A. Adeboye and other Anointed Ministers of God.

TRAINING WEEKEND

(DCE, RCBC, RCM & CRSM)

Date: JUNE 12TH-JUNE 15TH, 2025.

Venue: All PARISHES